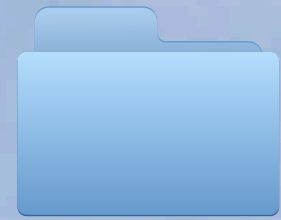
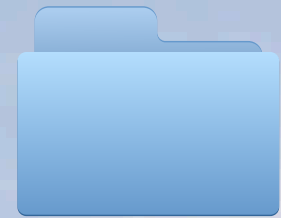


a less miserable way to look for work

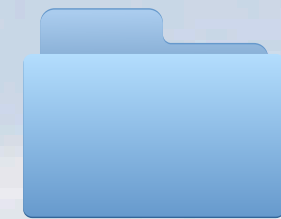


Lane 001:
People Ops



Lane 002:
Product Ops

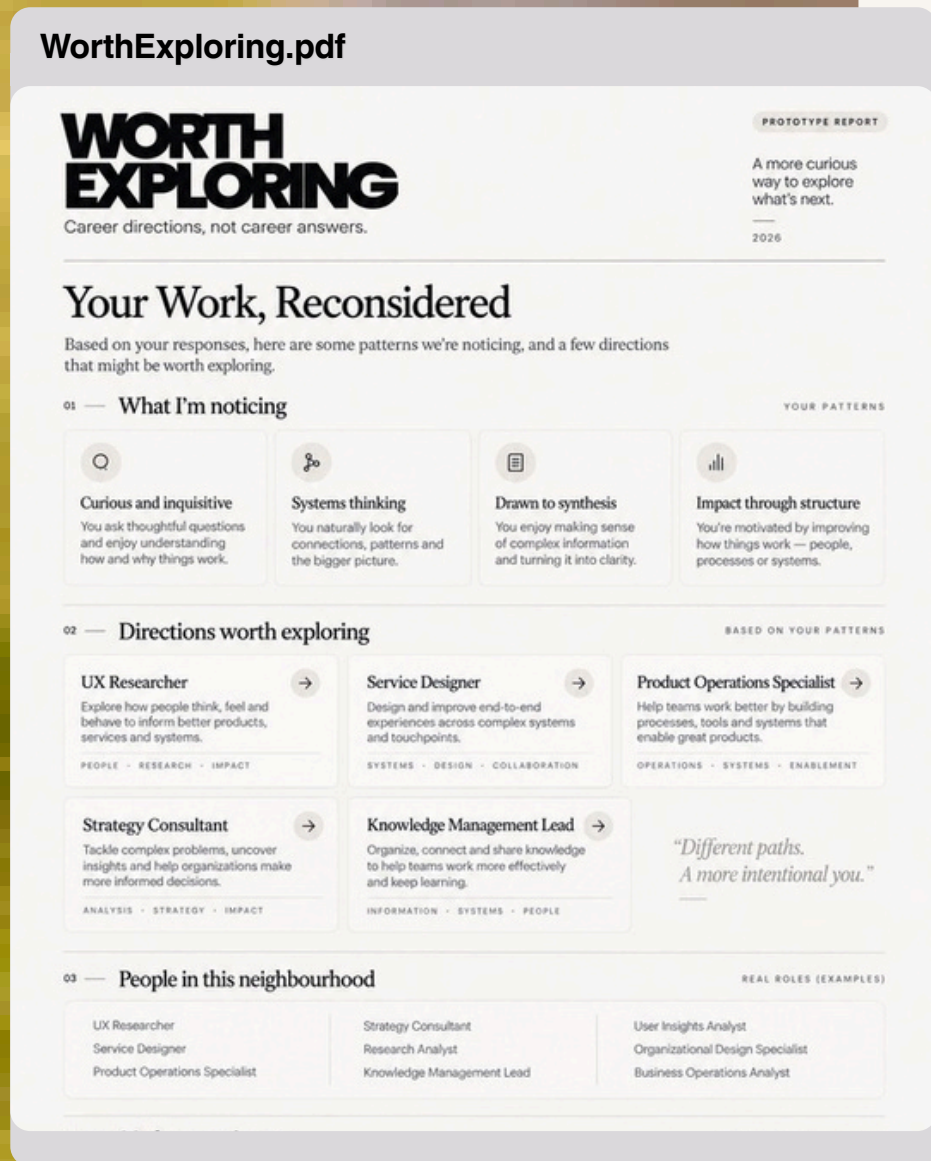
worth *searching*



Lane 003:
Project Work



A tiny guide for turning career exploration into an actual job search — without opening 47 tabs, applying to everything, or deciding you need a completely new life by Wednesday.



< Notes



The Back Story:

A few years into working life, I had the uncomfortable realization that I'd done everything I was supposed to do and still felt wildly mismatched with where I'd ended up.

I kept thinking about the younger versions of me: the marine biologist, the child psychologist, the girl who wanted to teach abroad and keep moving.

Different jobs. Same clues.

Curiosity. People. Variety. Meaning. Learning.

That question became *Worth Exploring*.

This guide is what came next:

How do you search for work without losing your mind?

before we *search*

(please don't open LinkedIn yet)

Job searching gets weird fast.

You start looking for one thing and suddenly you're:

- saving jobs you don't actually want
- questioning every qualification you have
- considering moving cities
- researching an unrelated master's degree
- somehow no closer to applying anywhere

Start with understanding what you're actually looking for.

< Notes



What You Need:

Pull out your Worth Exploring results — or a piece of paper!

More:

3 things you want more of at work

Less:

2 things you'd rather not do again

Must-haves:

salary / flexibility / location / mission / schedule / etc.

Worth Exploring:

2–3 directions you're curious about right now
(*not your destiny, just today's search filter*)

open your *mind*

Before you go looking for new jobs, acknowledge the little rules you've quietly collected:

- "I should only apply to jobs I'm perfectly qualified for."
- "If I change direction, I'm starting over."
- "If a job sounds impressive, I should probably want it."

Nope.

< Notes



affirmation

you are not trying to find ***The Career.***

You are trying to collect enough evidence to recognize what deserves another look.

That is much easier.

find your *formula*

It's not about finding the perfect job title.
It's about figuring out what makes you
stop scrolling.

< Notes



Search Lane:

A lane can mix:

TITLE + SKILL + ENVIRONMENT

Examples:

1. People Ops + systems + remote
2. Project work + research + health
3. Product Ops + process improvement + startup

Mix things around until the search results start looking a little more like you.

Remember: you are allowed to have more than one lane.

test the *daily*

Job descriptions are advertisements.

You don't need to meet every bullet — but you should probably want to do the actual work.

Before saving a role, ask: *does the Tuesday-afternoon version of this job sound good?*

Not the title. Not the company logo.
The tasks.

< Notes



This job has...

- ✓ 2+ things I want more of
- ✓ interesting actual responsibilities
- ✓ acceptable work conditions
- ✓ something useful to learn
- ✓ no immediate red flags

< Notes



protect your *brain*

Job boards are designed to keep producing jobs.
Your search does not need to keep consuming them.

TRY:

- search with a question, not “let’s see what’s out there”
- stop after 5 genuinely interesting finds
- turn off job-board notifications that create fake urgency
- save first, apply later
- give yourself an actual stopping time
- remember there will still be jobs tomorrow

More searching ≠ better searching.

warning: boring spreadsheet

Create a space to remember the jobs so your brain doesn't have to.

Job Title	Company	Search Lane	Status	Why I Saved This	Red Flags	Notes	Link

Or MAKE A COPY of this one.

Nothing fancy, just somewhere for the evidence to live.
Organize it in a way that makes sense to you.

check the *evidence*

Job searching shouldn't only produce applications.

It should produce information.

Your search is allowed to change when you learn something new.

< Notes



Weekly Check-in:

Ask yourself...

- What did I keep saving?
- What did I keep rejecting?
- What looked good until I read the actual work?
- Did anything unexpected keep showing up?

Remember:

The sheet isn't a scoreboard. It's evidence.



okay but *should I apply?*

You don't need a 100% match.

But before spending an hour on an application, ask:

- Do I actually want the work?
- Can I make a credible case that I could do it?
- Are there any real dealbreakers?
- Would I still want it if nobody was impressed by the title?

If those answers look reasonably good: apply.

You're not signing a lifelong contract.
You're starting a conversation.



internet not
answering the
question?

Ask someone who actually does the work:

- What takes up more of your week than people expect?
- What surprised you once you were actually doing it?
- What kind of person tends to enjoy this work?
- How could I test it before making a big move?

Network like a researcher, not a salesperson.

congrats, now
go job search
sanely :)